

BEYOND THE KINGDOM — Episode #0003: Media & Fan Layer

Companion to Script #BTK-0003 · Air Date: Wednesday, January 5, 2005

The world reacts to the birthday. News, gossip, and the 2005 internet from Wednesday night to Thursday morning.

THE ATLANTA SENTINEL — Thursday, January 6, 2005 · Home Edition · 50¢

FRONT PAGE

WEST END ON EDGE AHEAD OF PARK VICTIM'S FUNERAL

Whitlock to be buried Saturday; unmarked police car posted outside Merriweather & Sons

By Marcus Webb, Staff Writer

Lamar Whitlock, the 43-year-old West End man found shot to death in Piedmont Park on Monday, will be buried Saturday morning after an 11 a.m. service at Greater Cascade Baptist Church, his family announced Wednesday.

An unmarked Atlanta police car was seen parked across from Merriweather & Sons Funeral Home on Ralph David Abernathy Boulevard throughout the day Wednesday. The funeral home, which employed Whitlock part-time, is handling the arrangements. An APD spokesperson said only that "the department maintains a presence wherever community safety requires it."

Asked about reports that Deputy Chief Warren Hughes had objected to the cost of the surveillance, the spokesperson declined to comment. *(Continued on A6)*

BUSINESS · D1

DONOHUE HEIR TURNS 23; KEY TO 1936 HOTEL CHANGES HANDS

In a quiet ritual that DGH insiders say dates back more than a decade, Chairman Victor Donohue brought his grandson, Blackwater Security International founder Marc-Anthony Bullock, to the shuttered Hotel Donohue on Auburn Avenue at dawn Wednesday, his 23rd birthday. A company spokesperson confirmed only that "the Chairman gave his grandson a personal gift of historical significance."

Real estate analysts noted that the visit came as Smilley Estates continues to acquire options on Sweet Auburn parcels. "If you're the Donohues, you make sure the whole city knows who holds the key to that street," said one Midtown developer. "Literally."

Wednesday's closing prices (publicly traded Donohue affiliates):

Ticker	Company	Close	Change
DFN	Donohue Financial	\$186.10	+0.6%
DNRG	Donohue Energy	\$96.95	+0.6%
DPHR	Donohue Pharmaceuticals	\$143.35	+0.3%
DTEC	Donohue Technologies	\$62.40	+0.8%

LIVING · "BEHIND THE GATES" by Bernadette Sinclair

The Birthday. Darlings, I need to lie down.

I have attended forty years of Belmont Crest parties, and I have never seen three hundred people cry at the same time until Wednesday night at **Belle Rive**.

The Watch. At ten o'clock, **Simone Donohue**, 94, placed her late husband's 1936 gold pocket watch in the palm of her great-grandson, **Marc-Anthony Bullock**, and told him, "This was his. He'd want it ticking." I watched a sitting federal judge dab her eyes with a cocktail napkin. I watched a Georgia state senator blow his nose into a pocket square that cost more than my first car. I watched *myself* do something similar.

The Song. **Grace Bullock** performed "Crown Me" with a brand-new second verse written for her brother. I won't print the lyrics. I'll just tell you the organist from Greater Crest Tabernacle said "Amen" out loud.

The Gifts. A 1964 Patek Philippe from the parents. A 1969 Harley from an uncle who is still, we're told, "in Miami." And from cousin **Martin Olson**, a 1640 first edition of Machiavelli's *The Prince*, inscribed. The birthday boy thanked him graciously and then reminded the room, charmingly, that Machiavelli wrote it after being tortured. The room laughed. Cousin Martin laughed a half-second late.

The Duck. It's real. It's a swan in a crown, and it looks exactly like a duck that won the lottery. The CEO of Donohue Global Holdings ordered it lit "like a Broadway star." It was. Truly one of the great ducks.

Sightings:

- **Mayor Josephine Whitaker**, in sequins, spent a very cozy ten minutes in a certain study with the **Chairman**. Donation talk, surely.
- **Chief Elxa Jackson**, in simple black, ate shrimp standing up. The Chief never eats standing up.
- A slim young woman in a **black hoodie** was seen communing silently with the duck before vanishing with a slice of cake. Security, I'm told. Darling, I *love* this family's security.

And finally, a blind item that is not blind at all. At approximately 9:41 PM, a black **Maybach** bearing a certain Chicago family's vanity plate pulled up to the **Crown Gate**. The rear window lowered. My source saw **scarlet silk**. The guard picked up his radio to announce her.

And then the car **turned around**.

Two visits to one gate in three days, darlings. I'm no detective, but I've been to a few weddings.

WBKG CHANNEL 8 ACTION NEWS — WBKG.com

Posted 11:12 p.m., Wednesday, January 5, 2005

INSIDE ATLANTA'S PARTY OF THE YEAR

By Celeste Vaughn

Reporting live from the Crown Gate of Belmont Crest, WBKG's Celeste Vaughn brought viewers the sights and sounds of Marc-Anthony Bullock's 23rd birthday celebration at Belle Rive, where 320 guests, including Mayor Josephine Whitaker, celebrated into the night.

>> **PHOTO GALLERY:** The gowns, the cake, and yes, the duck (12 photos)

>> **POLL: Best moment of the Donohue party?**

The pocket watch — 51% · Grace's song — 29% · The duck — 20%

(3,977 votes. *This is not a scientific poll.*)

CRESTWATCH — crestwatch.blogspot.com

"All the news the gates keep out."

Thursday, January 06, 2005 — 12:21 AM

THE BIRTHDAY: A CRESTWATCH MINUTE-BY-MINUTE

Sources inside the ballroom. Sources inside the kitchen. Sources inside the POWDER ROOM. Let's go.

8:06 PM. The Queen Mother arrives in **white** pearls. Her butler is carrying a leather case under his arm all night. We all know what's in it. It never opened. *Or did it??*

8:32 PM. Cousin gives the birthday boy **The Prince**. Birthday boy gives cousin a history lesson. Somebody call the fire department, it's a BURN.

8:52 PM. The Mayor and the Chairman. The study. The door open *six inches*. CrestWatch has no further comment. CrestWatch doesn't need one.

9:09 PM. A certain grandmother in emerald and a certain young mother in borrowed black, **in the powder room, together, for four minutes**. Both came out with dry eyes. Our source says there was *laughing*. About hot sauce?

9:21 PM. The CEO air-kisses a certain senior law partner at the bar. It lasted exactly one second longer than necessary. Brrr.

9:41 PM. The Maybach. The scarlet. The gate. The U-turn. Bernadette got it too, but we got it FIRST. ;)

9:58 PM. The watch. We're not crying, you're crying.

10:10 PM. A girl in a hoodie. A duck. A thumbs-up. We don't understand it, and we don't need to.

Posted by CrestWatch at 12:21 AM · 214 comments

KingdomKween404 said... THE U-TURN. esther smiley came to the gate AGAIN?? she is FEENIN

PeachStateTea said... the prince comment... marc said "i'm funny" and then went for the NECK

ChiTownDiva said... leave esther alone. her family's at war with them. she was being POLITE

BuckheadBarbie said... polite is a card, sweetie. not a red valentino

KingdomKween404 said... the powder room thing... who was it?? the baker grandma and the pony lady???

CrestWatch said... A lady never says, darling. But you're warm. :-*

"FIND DEE" — finddee.livejournal.com

Wednesday, January 5th, 2005 — 11:58 pm

Current mood: hopeful

Current music: Grace Bullock, "Crown Me"

I met the DA tonight.

At a party. A very fancy party. Lyric's godfather turned 23, and he made me come, and I wore my cousin's dress and felt like Cinderella if Cinderella had student loans.

And the new District Attorney was there. Arianna Cummings. I made a fool of myself. I just started talking about Dee right in the middle of a birthday party, and I was so embarrassed.

But she was so kind. She said she's seen the flyers. The yellow ones. She said, "Come see me tomorrow. Ten o'clock."

Three years. Three years of detectives not calling back and flyers getting rained on. And the District Attorney of Fulton County looked me in the eye and said, "Come see me."

She looked like she'd seen a ghost when I said his name, though. I guess everybody does now. It's been so long.

10 AM. Wish me luck. Pray for me. Pray for Dee.

Tags: dee, DA, hope, tomorrow

27 comments

grady_nurse_lo (Loretta Divine): I'm coming with you. Don't argue.

cascadecutz: we'll keep his chair warm

E.O.S.: Proud of you. Call me the second you walk out. <3

spelman_sis_05: GO GET HIM BACK HARM

BLACKPLANET FORUMS — Atlanta > Music & Entertainment

Thread: GRACE BULLOCK SANG A NEW VERSE OF CROWN ME AT HER BROTHER'S BDAY

Started by **GraceStan_4Ever** — 01/05/2005 11:30 PM

GraceStan_4Ever: my cousin works for the catering company and she said grace changed the 2nd verse for her brother and grown men CRIED. somebody please tell me they recorded it

ATLien_4Life: somebody's cousin is gonna email it around by friday watch

MsSpelmanite: "just a boy with a crown in his yesterdays" is what my cousin said the line was. i'm not ok

SouthsideSaint_78: that family be crying at everything but the Smilleys be driving off from the gate lmaoo

ChiTownDiva: she was being RESPECTFUL. she came, she saw, she said happy birthday, she left. that's class

SouthsideSaint_78: class is walking IN. esther got scared

ChiTownDiva: esther smilley ain't never been scared of nothing in her life

KingdomKween404: then why'd she run? ;)

MYSPEACE BULLETINS

From: GRACE BULLOCK — Jan 6 2005 12:40 AM

Subject: thank u + i'm still crying

Tonight I sang for the best person I know. My big brother turned 23, and I wrote him a verse, and he cried, and then I cried, and then Nana Ruby told us both to stop crying on the cake. Love you Marc. Crown Me video next week, for real this time. — G

AIM AWAY MESSAGES (Wednesday night)

MarcAnthonyB: 23. tick tock. thank u everybody. (nana ruby, i know you know i had the 3rd slice)

HarmonyDivineRealty: DA 10am. please god.

Amond_B_Ops: "not yet."

KiaraB_BCA: mama came home from the party & sat in the kitchen & smiled. idk what happened but i'm not complaining

BRIELLEgetsitdone: the duck was a triumph. i will be accepting apologies in the form of gift cards.

CeleVaughnWBKG: kept a promise tonight. hope it was worth it.

ghost_000: i have seen the duck.

End of Media & Fan Layer, Episode #0003. Continued with Episode #0004 (Thursday, January 6, 2005).